setting even though several hours earlier we'd had sharp differences of opinion; maybe there was a little of Tip O'Neill in him. He could tell jokes about himself and even about his country, and I grew to like him more.

During our final business session earlier in the day, Gorbachev and I had discussed language for a joint statement that was to be issued at the close of the summit and that would make note of our mutual commitment to seek a fifty-percent cut in nuclear weapons and include references to several new cultural and diplomatic exchanges. Then, as I wrote in my diary, "we cut short the meeting and our teams went to work on the statement. He and I and the interpreters went into a small room and wound up telling stories." He asked a few questions about Hollywood, and we discovered we had had a few similar experiences dealing with our respective bureaucracies. We chatted for almost an hour, just the two of us, and then the two teams came in to show us a number of things they'd agreed on and several they were still working on. Then we broke up, so he and I could get ready for a reception hosted by the Swiss president.

After the reception Nancy and I hosted a dinner for the Gorbachevs at the villa we were using as our temporary home in Geneva. After dinner, we adjourned to the living room for coffee and conversation. Shortly after we were seated, senior officials from both sides, who had been in a different building working on the statement, came in and said they were at loggerheads over the language for the final document. The Soviets wanted to change something that had already been agreed upon. George Shultz was quite angry at this last-minute change. He pointed at the Soviet official responsible for the problem and said directly to General Secretary Gorbachev: "Mr. General Secretary, this man is not keeping the agreement you and President Reagan reached earlier today, and if we don't reach an